

Hari Prasad Gridharan

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EDUCATION

CORNELL UNIVERSITY, SC JOHNSON COLLEGE OF BUSINESS

Ithaca, NY

THE CHARLES H. DYSON SCHOOL OF APPLIED ECONOMICS AND MANAGEMENT

Expected May 2029

Candidate for Bachelor of Science in Applied Economics and Management, Minor in Artificial Intelligence

Dyson Scholar (top 10% of academic class) 2025-2026 | GPA: 3.7

Relevant Coursework: Computational Mathematics, Linear Algebra, Business Management, Management Communication

Activities and Societies: Entrepreneurship Club – President; Armada – Builder; South Asian Business Association

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ADOBE

Remote

AI/Strategy Consultant (Contract)

Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

- Advised on enterprise client strategy and product for \$1M+ client contracts; presented case to IT leadership at Fortune 500 firm
- Proposed business cases and product strategy currently in suite beta testing; presented to IT leadership on \$1M+ client contracts
- Built market sizing framework, user experience benchmarks, and positioning analyses to assess opportunities for AI applications

WIDGET FACTORY

Remote

Problem Design Engineer

Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

- Designed and engineered complex, real-world problem sets used to evaluate frontier AI models in training coding environments
- Benchmarked agent behavior and task completion used to inform iterative improvement to task design and environment quality
- Coordinated engineer feedback into tangible changes in model training and execution environments for production deployment

LEADERSHIP

ARMADA

Ithaca, NY

Builder

Jan 2026 - Present

- Led high-agency strategic projects across AI-native suite, partnered with VCs (\$200M+ AUM) at YC-backed startup community
- Engineered experimental projects across ML applications, code optimizers, full-stack web platforms, and drone synchronization
- Built Cornell founder directory; assisted founders with developing early-stage concepts through MVP creation and user scoping

CORNELL ENTREPRENEURSHIP CLUB

Ithaca, NY

President

Sep 2025 - Present

- Operated YC speaker series logistics (150+ attendees), coordinated directly with founders, VC firms, and startups to host events
- Generated 500,000+ views on Instagram/LinkedIn utilizing speaker content, event advertising, and technical project showcases
- Scouted and evaluated emerging student-led startups across tech verticals to develop investment theses and operational strategy

CORNELL DIGITAL TECH AND INNOVATION (DTI)

Ithaca, NY

Business Analyst

Sep 2025 - Present

- Executed strategic projects spanning go-to-market and data analysis of student-facing digital tools serving 15,000+ Cornell users
- Conducted competitive benchmarking across 8 peer platforms, delivered positioning and product strategies adopted by the team
- Identified growth levers through data analyses and experience reviews, created feature roadmap to improve engagement metrics

PROJECTS AND VENTURES

COMMIT: SOCIAL NETWORK PREDICTION MARKET PLATFORM

Ithaca, NY

Cofounder

Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

- Built AI-powered prediction market platform from concept to MVP; ranked top 10% among 20,000+ Y Combinator applicants
- Architected full stack application with frontend, backend, market maker engine, and PostgreSQL database management systems
- Conducted market sizing analysis, competitive landscape assessment of over 15 platforms, and developed unit economics model

AI-POWERED STARTUP DISCOVERY ENGINE

Ithaca, NY

Independent Project

Dec 2025 – Jan 2026

- Built AI-powered research tool, enabling semantic retrieval of companies spanning 50+ technical verticals for strategic sourcing
- Incorporated multi-factor scoring (founder backgrounds, patent data, market signals) to surface and rank investment candidates
- Deployed system as internal valuation and search tool; analytical framework directly applicable to dataset curation and research

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Finance & Business: Financial Modeling, Market Sizing, Competitive Analysis, MS Office (Word, Excel, PPTX), Client Relations

Technical: Python (pandas, scikit-learn), SQL, JavaScript/React, NLP/Embeddings, Statistical Analysis, AI Tools (Claude Code)

Interests: Cliff-Jumping, Hiking 14,000ft Mountains, Singing Indie and Carnatic Classical Music, Cooking Regional Indian Cuisine